Akelius Quiz Cards

World history

3 topics, 15 cards, English

A6 portrait, front and back

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How to read this file

- Each card has two pages, first the front and then the back. The pages are A6 portrait for printed cards and smartphones.
- Front: picture, clue text, question and four answers. Words in bold are explained on the back.
- Back: the answer in the exact words of the correct option, then the word explanations as text, picture or both.
- The front text is Verdana 11 where it fits and smaller where it does not. The footer shows the size.
- Every topic has five cards: grade 6, grade 9, two for grade 12 and university. Each card stands alone.
- All text has passed an independent historian review and an editor review. Every card also exists in Swedish.
- The pictures are AI-generated and reviewed one by one. A grey box marks a picture still in production.

Contents

1	Ancient Egypt: the pyramids	4
2	Mesopotamia: the first cities and writing	14
5	Socrates	24



Land X lies along one long river in Africa. Almost no rain falls there. But long ago, the river **flooded** every year. The flood left black **soil** on the fields. Farmers grew **wheat** in the black soil. The river still gives life to the whole land. The kings of Land X built huge stone **tombs**. The most famous tombs have a square bottom. The top is one point. The biggest one is about 4,500 years old. For thousands of years, it was the tallest building on Earth.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Mexico
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ China
- ☐ India

Egypt



soil
the earth where plants grow



wheat

flood: the river rises and water covers the land

tomb: a room or building for a dead person



Land X is a dry land by a long river. The king wants a **pyramid** for his body after he dies. There are no modern machines. Thousands of workers pull heavy stones on wooden **sledges**. They drag the stones up long **ramps** of earth and stone. They cut the stone with tools of copper, a soft metal. Today, **archaeologists** study the workers' village near the pyramids. The workers are not slaves. They get pay: bread, fish, and a place to sleep. How do you feed thousands of workers, day after day? Only a strong and well-planned land can do this.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Peru
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ Mexico

Egypt



sledge
a flat wooden board for pulling heavy things



archaeologist
a scientist who digs in the ground to learn about old times

pyramid: a building with a square bottom and one point at the top

ramp: a road that goes up, little by little



Why does a land build a mountain of stone? Land X lies by a long river, at the edge of a great **desert**. Its people believe their king is close to the gods. While the king still lives, they build him a huge stone **tomb**. It has a square bottom and one point at the top. When the king dies, they make his body into a **mummy**. They believe the body must last for the next life. The tomb is a message in stone: our king lives on. A building can show what people believe. Think of the biggest buildings today: **temples**, banks, towers, stadiums. What do they say about us?

Which land is this?

- ☐ China
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mexico
- ☐ Iraq

Egypt



desert

mummy: a dead body that is dried and wrapped so it lasts a very long time

tomb: a room or building for a dead person

temple: a building where people pray to a god



In Land X, a **scribe** sits by a field and counts sacks of wheat. He writes signs on **papyrus**. Picture-signs cover the temple walls. The scribes collect **taxes** for the king. Every year, the long river rises and covers the fields with water. The water leaves rich black earth on the fields. But the water also washes away the lines between the fields. So every year, people must measure the land again. All this measuring helps **geometry** grow. A big kingdom needs writing and mathematics. No scribes means no taxes, and no taxes means no pyramids.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ China
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Greece

Egypt



papyrus
a kind of paper; people make it from a river plant

scribe: a person whose work is writing and counting

tax: things people must give to the king or the state, like wheat or money

geometry: the mathematics of shapes and of measuring land



Land X is full of old picture-writing. The signs cover temple walls and the huge stone **tombs** of kings. For many hundreds of years, nobody can read them. More than 200 years ago, soldiers find a special stone by the river. On the stone, the same text is written three times, in three **scripts**. One script is old Greek, and **scholars** can read Greek. For many years, scholars compare the scripts, sign by sign. At last, they can read the picture-signs again. Now we can read the land's prayers, its laws, even its shopping lists. When a script is lost, a land's memory goes silent. **Archaeology** can give the voice back.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Persia
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ China

Egypt



archaeology
the study of things people from long ago leave behind

script: a set of signs for writing a language

scholar: a person who studies a subject very deeply

tomb: a room or building for a dead person



Land X lies between two big rivers, the Tigris and the Euphrates. The sun is hot, and there is little rain. So people dig **canals**. The canals carry river water to the fields. The fields give much **grain**, and the villages grow. The villages become the first big cities on earth. Over time, the cities get walls, markets, and tall **temple** towers. People press small signs into wet **clay**. It is the first writing that we know of. The name of this land means 'between the rivers'.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ India
- ☐ China

Mesopotamia



clay
soft, wet earth; it gets hard when it dries



grain

canal: a small river that people dig; it carries water to the fields

temple: a house for a god



The temple storehouses in Land X are full: grain, wool, oil, and sheep. The workers must count everything. Who brings ten sheep? Who gets three jars of oil? Memory alone is not enough. At first, people count with small clay **tokens**. The two big rivers, the Euphrates and the Tigris, give endless mud, and mud gives clay. Later, people press signs into wet clay with a cut **reed**. Over time, the signs become little **wedges**. The first writing that we know of is not a poem: it is **accounting**. Much later, people write letters, laws, and stories.

Which land is this?

- ☐ China
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ Phoenicia

Mesopotamia



reed

token: a small clay piece that stands for one thing, like one sheep

wedge: a small shape like the tip of a nail

accounting: counting goods and writing the numbers down



In Land X, between two big rivers, the fields need **canals**. Families must share the river water fairly. So they agree on shared rules and work together. The watered fields give more food than the farmers can eat. This extra food changes everything: some people can stop farming. They become builders, potters, priests, and traders. Each person learns one **craft** well. This is **specialization**. Soon thousands of **strangers** live together in one place: the first city. Today this land is mostly in Iraq. Maybe the city is the biggest invention that people ever make.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ the Indus Valley
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ China

Mesopotamia



canal
a small river that people dig; it brings water to the fields

specialization: when each person learns one job very well

craft: a special skill or job; you learn it with long practice

stranger: a person you do not know



The people of Land X write the oldest great story that we can still read. They write it on **clay tablets**. It tells about Gilgamesh, a king in the city of Uruk, between the rivers Euphrates and Tigris. Gilgamesh loses his best friend, and now he is afraid of death. He travels to the end of the world to find **eternal** life. He fails. A wise man tells him: no human lives forever. So Gilgamesh goes home. He learns to live well: build your city, love your people, enjoy your bread. How do we live well, when life is short? People ask this question 4,000 years ago, and we still ask it today.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ India
- ☐ Mesopotamia

Mesopotamia



tablet
a flat piece of clay for writing

eternal: forever, without end

clay: soft, wet earth; it gets hard when it dries

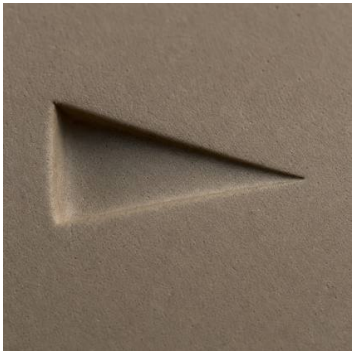


Paper burns, but clay dries hard and lasts almost forever. Land X is a hot plain between two rivers, the Tigris and the Euphrates. The plain has much river mud, but few trees and few stones. So the people write on soft clay tablets, and they leave us hundreds of thousands of them. There are laws and lists of kings, but also **receipts**, letters, and school exercises. One angry customer even complains about bad copper. For a long time, nobody can read the **wedge-shaped** signs. On a high rock in Persia, there is a king's message in three languages. **Scholars** compare the languages and learn to read the signs. Suddenly, everyday voices speak to us from about 4,000 years ago. **Durable** writing materials keep the small voices alive, not only the voices of kings.

Which land is this?

- [ ] Greece
- [ ] Egypt
- [ ] China
- [ ] Mesopotamia

Mesopotamia

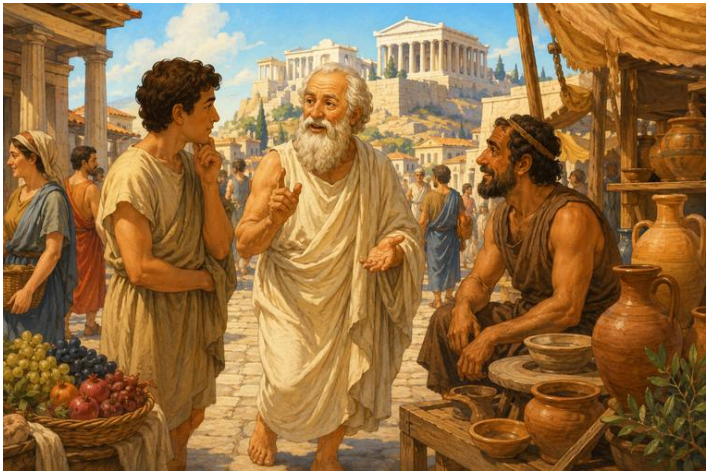


wedge-shaped looking like small triangles, wide at one end and sharp at the other

receipt: a note that shows what somebody buys or pays

scholar: a person who studies one subject very deeply

durable: strong; it lasts a very long time



Mr X lives long ago in Athens. Athens is a famous city in **ancient** Greece. He has a simple life. He often walks **barefoot**. All day he walks around the city. He talks with everyone: young people, workers, rich people. He teaches them, but he does not want money for it. He never writes a book.
- I only talk with people, he says.
- That is how I teach.
His students write down the words of Mr X. That is why we still know his ideas today.

Who is Mr X?

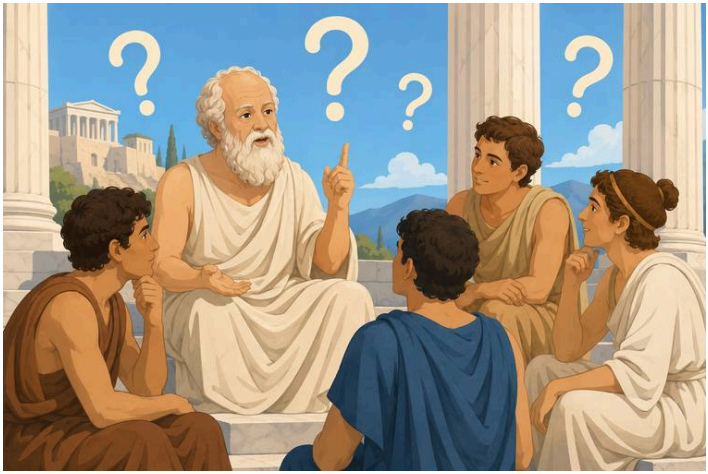
☐ Socrates
☐ Plato
☐ Aristotle
☐ Confucius

Socrates



barefoot

ancient: very old, from a time long ago



Mr X lives in Athens almost 2,500 years ago. When you ask him a question, he does not answer. He asks you a question back.
- What is your **reason**?
- Can you give an example?

Step by step, he tests each idea with you. Weak ideas fall. Strong ideas stay. He is famous for one **saying**: I know that I know nothing. He means: never be too sure of an idea. Schools today still use his way of asking. It also helps you check news, **rumors**, and **advertising**.

Who is Mr X?

☐ Socrates
☐ Plato
☐ Buddha
☐ Aristotle

Socrates



rumor
a story people tell each other, but no one checks if it is true

reason: why you think something is true

saying: a short sentence that many people know and repeat

advertising: words and pictures that try to make you buy something



Athens loses a long war. The people are afraid and angry. Mr X is an old man, famous for his hard questions. Three men take him to court.
- He leads the young people the wrong way, they say.
- He does not respect the gods of our city.

A **jury** of about 500 normal people votes: **guilty**. The court says: he must die. His friends want to help him run away, but he says no. He will not stop asking questions, and he will not run away. He calmly drinks a cup of **poison** and dies. His **trial** leaves us a big question: what may a country do to a thinker?

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☐ Gandhi
- ☐ Nelson Mandela

Socrates



jury
a group of normal people who vote in court: did he do it or not?

trial: when a court (the place of judges) decides: did a person do a crime?

guilty: the court says: yes, he did it

poison: a thing that kills you when you drink or eat it



Mr X walks through Athens. He stops people and talks with them. He stops the rich and important people too.
- You want money and **fame**, he says.
- But do you care for your **soul**?
He believes a good soul matters more than gold. He says: when you do wrong, you hurt yourself most of all. A man who **cheats** hurts his own soul. He also says: the **unexamined** life is not worth living. He means: stop and ask yourself, do I live in a good way? His questions show that the powerful men often know little. That is why many powerful men become his enemies.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Aristotle
- ☐ Buddha
- ☐ Confucius

Socrates

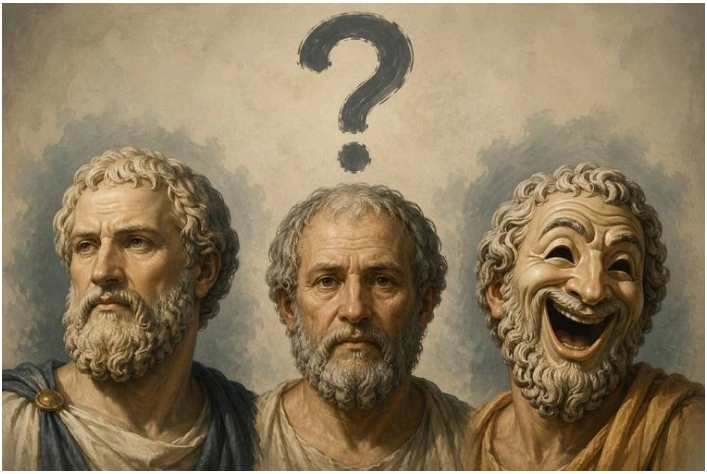


cheat
to lie or trick people to win or get money

soul: the inner part of you: your thoughts, feelings, and character

fame: when many people know your name

unexamined: not checked, not looked at



Mr X writes nothing. But he changes thinking forever. We know him only through the books of other people. His student Plato writes many **dialogues** about him. Another student, Xenophon, shows a simpler man of daily life. A comedy writer in Athens laughs at him on stage. The three pictures of him are not the same. **Experts** still ask: who is the real man? His method is **refutation**. He questions each **claim** until it cannot stand. This method starts ethics, the study of right and wrong. Later, Aristotle turns this testing into logic, the study of good arguments.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Plato
- ☐ Confucius
- ☐ Buddha

Socrates



expert
a person who knows very much about one thing

dialogue: a written talk between two or more people

refutation: showing, step by step, that an idea cannot stand

claim: something a person says is true